



San Mateo County CA SO Transparency Portal

Last updated: Sun Jul 12 2026

OVERVIEW

San Mateo County CA SO uses Flock Safety technology to capture objective evidence without compromising on individual privacy. San Mateo County CA SO utilizes retroactive search to solve crimes after they've occurred. Additionally, San Mateo County CA SO utilizes real time alerting of hotlist vehicles to capture wanted criminals. In an effort to ensure proper usage and guardrails are in place, they have made the below policies and usage statistics available to the public.

POLICIES

What's Detected

License Plates, Vehicles

What's Not Detected

Facial recognition, People, Gender, Race

Acceptable Use Policy

Data is used for law enforcement purposes only.
Data is owned by San Mateo County CA SO and is never sold to 3rd parties.

Prohibited Uses

Immigration enforcement, traffic enforcement, harrassment or intimidation, usage based solely on a protected class (i.e. race, sex, religion), Personal use.

Access Policy

All system access requires a valid reason and is stored indefinitely.

Hotlist Policy

Hotlist hits are required to be human verified prior to action.

USAGE

Data Retention

The number of days data is retained.

30 days

Total Cameras

Number of LPR and other cameras.

109

Sharing Network Data With

Organizations granted access to San Mateo County CA SO data.	
Alameda CA PD	Alameda County CA SO
Albany CA PD	Alhambra CA PD
Anaheim CA PD	Anderson CA PD
Angels Camp CA PD	Antioch CA PD
Arcadia CA PD	Atherton CA PD
Barstow CA PD	Bear Valley Springs CA PD
Beaumont CA PD	Belmont CA PD

Hotlists Alerted On

National and statewide hotlist sources.

California SVS, NCMEC Amber Alert

Vehicles detected in the last 30 days

Number of unique plate reads over the last 30 days.

1,254,365

Number of Hotlist Hits

Total hotlist hits over the last 30 days.

8,853

Number of Searches

Total user search sessions over the last 30 days.

1,197

ADDITIONAL INFO

San Mateo Sheriff's Office ALPR Policy

https://www.smcsheriff.com/sites/default/files/content_files/Automated_License_Plate_Readers_ALPRs_0.pdf

Success Story - Occupied Stolen Vehicle

On Sunday, 07/05/26, at about 5:30am, deputies received a FLOCK alert regarding a vehicle with stolen license plates in the area of Woodside Rd. and Alameda De Las Pulgas. By tracking the suspect vehicle via FLOCK, deputies were able to locate the occupied vehicle in the 100 block of Northgate Dr. in Woodside. Deputies successfully stopped the vehicle and during a thorough investigation, discovered that both the vehicle and the license plates were stolen. The occupants of the vehicle also possessed possible ID theft information, several other stolen license plates, a variety of power tools, and suspected methamphetamine. The stolen vehicle was ultimately released to the registered owner. Both suspects were arrested and booked into the San Mateo County Jail for violations of numerous criminal statutes. FLOCK was integral to the identification and location of the suspect vehicle. This case highlights how proactive enforcement and the use of FLOCK can solve crimes and prevent future ones.

Success Story - Felony Hit & Run

On 07/01/26, at approximately 6:45 p.m., deputies responded to Woodside Rd. and Hacienda Dr. in Woodside following a reported hit-and-run collision. Upon arrival, deputies learned the victim was riding a horse along the shoulder of the road, which is commonly used by bicyclists and equestrians, when a vehicle struck the horse from behind and fled the scene. Both the horse and rider sustained injuries but survived. Through witness statements and investigative tools, including FLOCK, deputies identified the involved vehicle and registered owners. Deputies are continuing to conduct follow-up investigative work, including collecting and reviewing all available evidence. The use of FLOCK greatly reduced the time it took for deputies to identify the suspect vehicle.

Success Story - Residential Burglary

On 06/15/2026, deputies investigated a report of a 2-day old residential burglary in the Town of Woodside. Home security footage showed two suspects entering the garage on the property and rummaging through items. When the home's alarm system activated, the suspects fled. Deputies reviewed the footage, which showed the vehicle the suspects were driving. Using FLOCK, deputies identified the vehicle and focused their investigation. On 06/16/26, deputies located the vehicle in Redwood City. Two suspects were arrested for PC 460(A): Residential Burglary. Though this case was reported 2-days after the crime occurred, FLOCK allowed deputies to quickly identify and arrest the suspects.

Success Story - Road Rage / Firearm / Narcotics

On 06/14/2026, around 8:30 p.m., deputies were dispatched to a location in Montara following reports of a road rage incident. During the incident, the suspect reportedly pointed a firearm at the victim, was speeding, and driving erratically. The suspect fled the area, but witnesses were able to provide a description of the suspect and the vehicle he was driving. Using FLOCK, deputies identified the vehicle and were able to focus their search efforts. A short time later, deputies located the suspect nearby. During the investigation, deputies located a semi-automatic firearm, ammunition, narcotics, illegal fireworks, and a false registration tab in the suspect's possession. The suspect, who was already prohibited from possessing firearms, was arrested on several charges including: PC 245(A)(2): Assault with a firearm, PC 29800(a)(1): Felon in possession of a firearm, and HS 11351: Possession of a controlled substance for sale. The use of FLOCK in this case greatly shortened the time it took for deputies to locate and safely arrest a dangerous felon.

Success Story - Stolen Vehicle

On 06/06/2026, Sheriff's Deputies in unincorporated Redwood City were alerted to a stolen vehicle in the area, via a FLOCK notification. Deputies responded to the area and quickly located the occupied vehicle. Deputies initiated a traffic stop but the driver failed to yield, which led to a short vehicle pursuit. At the conclusion of the pursuit, deputies safely and successfully took the juvenile driver into custody. The driver was also in possession of burglary tools. He was arrested for possession of a stolen vehicle, evading a peace officer with wanton disregard for public safety, and possession of burglary tools. This case highlights the effectiveness of using FLOCK's automated license plate reader (ALPR) technology in supporting public safety and preventing future crimes.

Success Story - Best Buy Serial Computer/Laptop Thief

On 02/23/2024 and 03/23/2024, a suspect entered the Best Buy in San Carlos and stole multiple computers and laptops valued at approximately \$3,000. A suspect vehicle was observed fleeing the scene, and FLOCK enabled deputies to obtain a license plate for the vehicle. Detectives identified a family member of the registered vehicle owner who matched the suspect's description. It was discovered that this suspect had committed similar thefts at Best Buy stores throughout the Bay Area. Detectives and deputies learned of a new suspect vehicle being used by the perpetrator, and FLOCK assisted in identifying this vehicle. In April 2024, deputies and detectives monitored the suspect and the vehicle in question. The suspect returned to the Best Buy in San Carlos on 04/27/2024, where he was arrested for the previous thefts.

Success Story - Arson via Molotov Cocktail

On 05/16/2024, around 3:00am, a suspect threw a Molotov cocktail at a residence in San Carlos. The fire spread rapidly, resulting in the destruction of two vehicles, part of a residential garage, some exterior property, and a section of a tree. Fortunately, the residents managed to escape the area unharmed. Using surveillance video and FLOCK, investigators identified a suspect vehicle that left the area shortly after the incident. With this information, they were able to develop additional leads on the suspect. Search warrants were issued and investigators obtained additional surveillance footage and FLOCK images, which clearly linked the suspect to the arson. This information resulted in the arrest of a suspect, who was prosecuted for arson of an inhabited structure by the San Mateo County District Attorney.

Success Story - Residential Burglary/Package Thefts from Apartments

On 08/06/2024 and 08/07/2024, during the early morning hours, two suspects entered different apartment buildings in San Carlos without access or authorization. These suspects entered the mailrooms and stole multiple packages from both buildings. Using surveillance video, detectives obtained descriptions of the suspects and their vehicle. Through FLOCK, a suspect vehicle was located. Detectives and deputies identified one of the involved suspects, who was on post-release community supervision out of Alameda County. They arranged for the probation officer to bring the suspect into the Hayward Probation Office. Detectives contacted the suspect at the office and found additional evidence related to these cases. This case is under review by the San Mateo County District Attorney for prosecution.